

The Spirit of Lust

Recognizing It, Renouncing It, Walking Free

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai.

I say to you that everyone who looks at a woman to lust after her has already committed adultery with her in his heart.

MATTHEW 5:28

THE HEART OF IT

Lust is not only what the eyes see. It is a spirit that hijacks a desire YHWH made good and turns it against his design. Scripture does not leave us guessing about its fruit, and it does not leave us without a door out. This handout is a mirror, not a checklist for your neighbor. Bring it into the light and let YHWH search your own heart first.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHERE TO READ IT
It begins in the heart	Matthew 5:28; James 1:14-15
It is a work of the flesh	Galatians 5:19-21
It cannot bear the light	Ephesians 5:11-13
It is broken by confession and renouncing	1 John 1:9; James 4:7-10
It ends in restored identity	1 Corinthians 6:9-11

SECTION ONE

It Begins in the Heart

Yahshua went straight past behavior and named the place where this starts.

I say to you that everyone who looks at a woman to lust after her has already committed adultery with her in his heart.

MATTHEW 5:28

He is not lowering the standard or raising it arbitrarily. He is telling you where the battle actually is. A man can keep his hands clean his whole life and still be handing his heart over daily. That is why willpower alone never sets anyone free. Willpower manages the hands. Yahshua goes after the heart, because the heart is what he is after in all of it.

James lays out the sequence plainly, and every one of us can trace our own story in it.

But each one is tempted when he is drawn away by his own lust and enticed. Then the lust, when it has conceived, bears sin. The sin, when it is full grown, produces death.

JAMES 1:14-15

Notice there is a gap between drawn away and conceived. That gap is where freedom lives. Once desire is entertained, fed, replayed, and protected, it conceives, and what is conceived always gets born. Most people try to fight at the delivery room. Scripture tells you to deal with it at the door.

Paul names it in the list of things that war against the Spirit.

Now the deeds of the flesh are obvious, which are: adultery, sexual immorality, uncleanness, lustfulness.

GALATIANS 5:19

SAY IT PLAINLY

Desire itself is not the enemy. YHWH made it, and inside covenant he calls it good and even commands delight in it (Proverbs 5:18-19; Song of Solomon 4:9-10; 1 Corinthians 7:3-5). Lust is that same good desire pulled out of covenant and pointed at whatever is in front of it. The enemy has never created a single appetite. He only counterfeits and redirects what YHWH already made.

SECTION TWO

Five Fingerprints of This Spirit

Scripture describes a consistent pattern where this spirit is at work in a life. These five traits are not a personality test. They are fingerprints, and they are here so you can recognize them in your own house before they take root.

1. Insatiability. Never satisfied, always pursuing more. What satisfied last year does not satisfy now, so the appetite escalates. That escalation is the tell.

Sheol and Abaddon are never satisfied; and a man's eyes are never satisfied.

PROVERBS 27:20

2. Deception and self justification. It always builds a case for itself. It renames things. It calls it curiosity, art, research, relaxation, or just how men are. A person under it can sin and genuinely feel they have done nothing wrong.

So is the way of an adulterous woman: she eats and wipes her mouth, and says, I have done nothing wrong.

PROVERBS 30:20

3. Objectification. It turns image bearers into things to be used. Every person you look at was made in the image of YHWH (Genesis 1:27). The moment a person becomes a means to your appetite, something in you has agreed with a lie about who they are and who you are.

That each one of you know how to control his own body in sanctification and honor, not in the passion of lust, even as the Gentiles who do not know Elohim.

1 THESSALONIANS 4:4-5

4. Secrecy and darkness. This spirit builds rooms nobody is allowed into: deleted history, a second account, a locked phone, a story that has to be managed. Anything that has to stay hidden to survive is already telling you what it is.

Have no fellowship with the unfruitful deeds of darkness, but rather even reprove them. For the things which are done by them in secret, it is a shame even to speak of. But all things, when they are reproved, are revealed by the light.

EPHESIANS 5:11-13

5. Restlessness of spirit. An inner drivenness that is not rooted in love but in appetite. Love can wait, can be told no, and can be at peace. Appetite cannot sit still. If you cannot be alone, bored, or unstimulated without reaching for something, that restlessness is information.

But the wicked are like the troubled sea; for it can't rest, and its waters cast up mire and dirt.

ISAIAH 57:20

FINGERPRINT	SCRIPTURE
Insatiability	Proverbs 27:20; Ecclesiastes 1:8; Habakkuk 2:5
Deception and self justification	Proverbs 30:20; Jeremiah 17:9; Proverbs 16:2

FINGERPRINT	SCRIPTURE
Objectification	Genesis 1:27; 1 Thessalonians 4:3-5; 2 Samuel 11:2-4
Secrecy and darkness	Ephesians 5:11-13; John 3:19-20; Proverbs 28:13
Restlessness of spirit	James 1:14-15; Isaiah 57:20-21; Proverbs 6:27-28

SECTION THREE

A Mirror, Not a Microscope

None of us are exempt from being tested here. The list above is not there so you can diagnose your spouse, your brother, or the man teaching on Saturday night. The second a checklist becomes a microscope pointed at someone else, pride has already gotten hold of it, and pride is the one thing that guarantees you stay stuck.

Search me, Elohim, and know my heart. Try me, and know my thoughts. See if there is any wicked way in me, and lead me in the everlasting way.

PSALM 139:23-24

Pray that before you read anything else in this handout again. Ask him to search you, then sit still long enough to let him answer. He is not looking for a way to condemn you. He is looking for a door you have left open, and he is pointing at it because he wants it shut.

Therefore let him who thinks he stands be careful that he doesn't fall.

1 CORINTHIANS 10:12

TWO THINGS TO HOLD TOGETHER

Everyone is tested here, and no one is beyond help here. Paul says in the very next verse that no temptation has taken you except what is common to man, and that YHWH is faithful and will make the way of escape (1 Corinthians 10:13). Common to man means you are not a special case. Way of escape means there is always a door, and it is always his to open.

SECTION FOUR

Conviction Is Not Condemnation

If you saw yourself in section two, pay close attention to what you do with that feeling, because two very different voices show up at this exact moment and they sound similar at first.

CONVICTION, THE RUACH	CONDEMNATION, THE ACCUSER
Names the specific thing	Names you as the thing

CONVICTION, THE RUACH	CONDEMNATION, THE ACCUSER
Draws you toward YHWH	Drives you away from him to hide
Leaves hope attached to it	Leaves hopelessness and shame
Produces repentance and life	Produces despair and more secrecy

For godly sorrow produces repentance leading to salvation, which brings no regret. But the sorrow of the world produces death.

2 CORINTHIANS 7:10

Shame says hide it. The Ruach says bring it into the light, because light is where things die. If you feel drawn toward YHWH in the middle of this, that is not you getting away with something. That is him coming after you, and the fact that you still feel it is mercy.

There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Messiah Yahshua, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit.

ROMANS 8:1

SECTION FIVE

The Way Out, Step by Step

This is the order that actually breaks things, and the order matters. Most people jump straight to trying harder, which is step nowhere. Walk it through in sequence.

Conviction. Agree with what he just showed you. No softening the language, no comparing yourself to someone worse. Call the thing what he calls it.

Confession. Say it out loud to YHWH, and where it is right to do so, to a trusted brother or sister who will pray and not gossip. Secrecy is the oxygen. Confession cuts the supply.

If we confess our sins, he is faithful and righteous to forgive us the sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

1 JOHN 1:9

Confess your offenses to one another, and pray for one another, that you may be healed.

JAMES 5:16

Renounce the stronghold. Confession admits it. Renouncing breaks agreement with it. Out loud, in the name of Yahshua, you tell it plainly that you are no longer in agreement with it, that it has no claim, and that every door you opened is now closed. This is not a formula or a ritual. It is you verbally taking back ground you handed over.

Be subject therefore to Elohim. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you. Draw near to Elohim, and he will draw near to you.

JAMES 4:7-8

Forgive. This is the step most people skip, and it is the one that holds the door open. Forgive whoever wounded you, including whoever exposed you to this in the first place, and forgive yourself the way he already has. Pride is the root of unforgiveness, and unforgiveness is legal ground. Humility is the root of forgiveness, and forgiveness is the root of deliverance.

For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

MATTHEW 6:14-15

Restore. If this spirit caused you to wound someone, go make it right. Not a vague apology, and not a confession that dumps details on someone in order to relieve your own conscience. Name what you did, own it with no excuse attached, and ask forgiveness. Where restitution is owed, pay it.

If therefore you are offering your gift at the altar, and there remember that your brother has anything against you, leave your gift there before the altar, and go your way. First be reconciled to your brother, and then come and offer your gift.

MATTHEW 5:23-24

Walk free in identity. Deliverance is not shame. It is the doorway back to who you actually are. Paul lists the exact sins this handout deals with, and then says the most important four words in the whole subject.

Such were some of you, but you were washed. But you were sanctified. But you were justified in the name of Adonai Yahshua, and in the Spirit of our Elohim.

1 CORINTHIANS 6:11

SUCH WERE SOME OF YOU

Were. Past tense. He does not say you are the sum of what you did, and he does not put you on probation. Washed, sanctified, justified. If YHWH has moved it to past tense, you do not get to keep dragging it back into the present and calling that humility. That is agreement with the accuser wearing humble clothes.

SECTION SIX

Guarding What He Cleaned

Yahshua warned about a house swept clean and left empty (Matthew 12:43-45). Renouncing empties the house. What you fill it with decides whether you stay free. Freedom is kept the same way it was received, by walking with him daily, not by white knuckling it alone.

- ◆ **Make a covenant with your eyes.** Job did, and he said it out loud as a settled decision, not a hope (Job 31:1; Psalm 101:3).
- ◆ **Cut off the access point.** Yahshua used deliberately extreme language about removing what causes you to stumble (Matthew 5:29-30). Filters, no phone in the bedroom, an app deleted, a route changed, a friendship ended. Whatever it actually takes.
- ◆ **Flee instead of fighting.** Scripture never tells you to stand your ground here. It tells you to run (1 Corinthians 6:18; 2 Timothy 2:22). Joseph left the coat and got out of the house (Genesis 39:12).
- ◆ **Do not feed it.** Make no provision for the flesh (Romans 13:14). Most falls are decided hours earlier, in the small allowance nobody saw.
- ◆ **Fill the space with his word and worship.** Guard your heart, because everything flows out of it (Proverbs 4:23), and set your mind on what is true, honorable, pure, and lovely (Philippians 4:8).
- ◆ **Walk in the light with someone.** One person who can ask you the hard question and will pray instead of talk (James 5:16; Ecclesiastes 4:9-10).
- ◆ **If you are married, pour it back into your covenant.** Delight in the spouse of your youth on purpose (Proverbs 5:18-19; 1 Corinthians 7:3-5).

But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you won't fulfill the lust of the flesh.

GALATIANS 5:16

And if you stumble, the answer is not to start the hiding cycle over. Come back into the light the same day. A righteous man falls seven times and rises again (Proverbs 24:16). The direction of your walk matters more than the perfection of it.

SECTION SEVEN

Pray It Out Loud

Words matter. You did not get here silently, and you do not get free silently. Pray this out loud, slowly, and fill in the blanks with the specific things he brings to mind. A fuller version of this prayer is available as a separate printable page.

PRAYER OF RENOUNCING

Father YHWH, I come to you in the name of Yahshua. I am not hiding anything from you today. I confess that I have given my eyes, my thoughts, and my desire to what you did not give me, specifically this: _____. I agree with you about it. I call it what you call it, and I am done defending it.

I renounce the spirit of lust and every agreement I have made with it, knowingly or in ignorance. I renounce every image, every fantasy, and every soul tie formed outside your covenant, and I break agreement with all of it in the name of Yahshua. It has no claim on me, no ground in me, and no say over me. Every door I opened, I close now by the blood of Yahshua.

I forgive those who wounded me and those who first put this in front of me, and I release them fully. I receive your forgiveness, and I forgive myself, because you have already washed me. Where I have wounded someone, give me the humility to go make it right.

Wash me with water by the word. Fill the place this used to occupy with your Ruach so it does not sit empty. Restore my sight, restore my desire to your design, and restore me to who you say I am. I belong to you. I am washed, I am sanctified, I am justified in the name of Yahshua. Amen.

CROSS REFERENCE

Index of Scripture

The heart of the matter

Matthew 5:27-30; James 1:14-15; Proverbs 4:23; Mark 7:20-23; Jeremiah 17:9-10

Named among the works of the flesh

Galatians 5:19-24; Colossians 3:5-7; Ephesians 5:3-7; 1 Peter 4:1-3

Never satisfied

Proverbs 27:20; Ecclesiastes 1:8; Habakkuk 2:5; Proverbs 30:15-16

Deception and self justification

Proverbs 30:20; Proverbs 16:2; Proverbs 21:2; Jeremiah 17:9; 1 John 1:8

People as image bearers

Genesis 1:27; 1 Thessalonians 4:3-8; 2 Samuel 11:2-4; Job 31:1

Secrecy and the light

Ephesians 5:8-14; John 3:19-21; Proverbs 28:13; Luke 8:17; Numbers 32:23

Search me and know me

Psalms 139:23-24; Psalm 19:12-14; Psalm 51:1-12; Lamentations 3:40

Conviction, not condemnation

Romans 8:1-2; 2 Corinthians 7:9-11; John 16:8; Revelation 12:10-11

Confession and cleansing

1 John 1:7-9; James 5:16; Proverbs 28:13; Psalm 32:3-5

Renouncing and resisting

James 4:6-10; 2 Corinthians 10:3-5; Ephesians 4:27; Ephesians 6:10-18; 1 Peter 5:6-9

Forgiveness as the door

Matthew 6:14-15; Matthew 18:21-35; Ephesians 4:31-32; Colossians 3:13; Mark 11:25

Making it right

Matthew 5:23-24; Luke 19:8; Numbers 5:6-7; Romans 12:18

Fleeing and guarding

1 Corinthians 6:18-20; 2 Timothy 2:22; Genesis 39:7-12; Romans 13:14; Philippians 4:8; Matthew 5:29-30

Filling the house

Matthew 12:43-45; Galatians 5:16-25; Romans 12:1-2; Colossians 3:1-5

Washed, sanctified, justified

1 Corinthians 6:9-11; Titus 3:3-7; 2 Corinthians 5:17; Romans 6:11-14; John 8:34-36

Desire inside covenant

Proverbs 5:15-19; Song of Solomon 4:9-10; 1 Corinthians 7:2-5; Hebrews 13:4

Notes

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.